

Lumbar L4-L5 - PT And Self-Management Plan

Mild L4-L5 disc degeneration diagnosed 2023, managed with physiotherapy and ibuprofen as needed. Overseen by Dr. James Okafor at Ridgefield Ortho. This is my own medical detail and stays private. Plan reviewed October 2026.

Daily Routine

- Morning: cat-camel, knee-to-chest, gentle hip flexor stretch.
- Core: dead-bugs, bird-dogs, side planks - the back-protective set, done most days.
- Glute bridges and hip hinges to keep the chain strong.

On A Flare

- Short course of ibuprofen with food; mind the stomach.
- Keep moving gently, avoid bed rest, no heavy lifting or loaded bending.
- Drop the bodyweight push and leg days; hold the mobility work only.
- If it does not settle in a week, contact Dr. Okafor's office.

Shift Considerations

Twelve hours on my feet is the real load. Supportive shoes, micro-breaks to reset posture between cases, and the mobility work after. Review at the January 2027 physical.